

In contrast, Michelangelo was a man who saw things through. When someone wanted him to carve a marble statue, the first thing he did was go to the quarry and pick out the stone himself. He took two years to sculpt the *Pietà*, an image of the Virgin Mary holding the wounded Jesus in her arms.



Later, he spent four years painting the ceiling of the Sistine Chapel in Rome—made all the more difficult by the fact he had to lie on his back while painting. Michelangelo never gave up.

Leonardo gave up all the time. Or, if he didn't actually give up, he simply became distracted and turned his attention to other things.

When he returned to Florence, his mind was focused on a new commission. He was staying as a guest at a local monastery, the Santissima Annunziata.

